

Document Management Guide

Document Information

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1. Introduction

Document management is the systematic process of creating, organizing, storing, retrieving, protecting, updating, archiving, and disposing of digital documents. A well-managed document system improves efficiency, reduces data loss, and ensures that information remains accurate and accessible throughout its lifecycle.

This guide explains how documents should be managed within the **Professional Digital Filing System**.

2. Purpose

The purpose of this guide is to:

- Standardize document management practices.
 - Improve document organization.
 - Simplify file retrieval.
 - Protect important information.
 - Support consistent documentation.
 - Promote professional records management.
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3. What is Document Management?

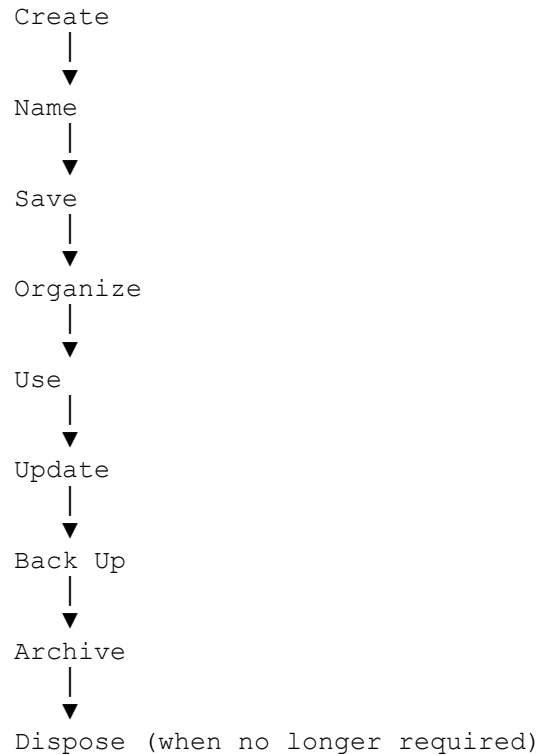
Document management is the process of controlling documents from creation to disposal.

It includes:

- Document creation
 - File naming
 - Folder organization
 - Storage
 - Retrieval
 - Editing
 - Version control
 - Backup
 - Security
 - Archiving
 - Disposal
-

4. Document Lifecycle

Every document should follow a structured lifecycle.



5. Types of Documents

The filing system supports various document types, including:

Administrative Documents

- Policies
- Procedures
- Meeting minutes
- Internal memos

Financial Documents

- Budgets
- Invoices
- Receipts
- Financial reports

Academic Documents

- Assignments
- Lecture notes
- Research papers
- Projects

Project Documents

- Project plans
- Progress reports
- Completion reports
- Evaluation reports
- Presentations

Personal Documents

- Curriculum Vitae (CV)
- Certificates
- Identification documents
- Career plans

Reference Materials

- Templates
- Guides
- Manuals
- Checklists

6. Document Classification

Documents should be classified according to their purpose.

Category	Examples
Administrative	Policies, Procedures
Financial	Invoices, Budgets
Academic	Assignments, Notes
Project	Reports, Documentation
Personal	CV, Certificates
Reference	Guides, Templates

Proper classification improves organization and retrieval.

7. Document Storage

Store every document in its designated folder.

Example:

```
Professional Digital Filing System
├── 04 Projects
│   ├── Organize a Professional Digital Filing System
│   │   ├── Documentation
│   │   │   ├── Reports
│   │   │   ├── Procedures
│   │   │   ├── Guides
│   │   │   ├── References
│   │   │   └── Templates
```

Avoid storing important files permanently on the Desktop or in the Downloads folder.

8. Document Naming Standards

All documents should follow the approved naming convention.

Examples:

```
Digital Filing System Project Plan.pdf
2026-07-05_ProjectMeetingMinutes.docx
Volume02_Chapter01_CRM.docx
```

Refer to the **File Naming Convention Guide** for complete standards.

9. Document Version Control

When revising documents, use version numbers.

Example:

```
Project Report_V1.docx
Project Report_V2.docx
```

Version control helps prevent confusion and preserves document history.

10. Document Retrieval

Documents can be located by:

- Folder navigation
- File Explorer search
- Filename
- Keywords
- File type
- Date modified

Ensure filenames are descriptive to improve search accuracy.

11. Document Security

Protect important documents by:

- Using Windows account passwords.
 - Applying folder permissions where necessary.
 - Restricting access to confidential documents.
 - Backing up sensitive files regularly.
 - Avoiding unauthorized sharing.
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12. Backup and Recovery

To prevent data loss:

- Perform weekly backups.
- Back up before major updates.
- Store backups on an external drive or cloud storage.
- Test backup files periodically.

Store backups in:

13. Archive Management

Move inactive documents to:

10 Archive

Archived files should:

- Remain organized.
- Follow the same naming convention.
- Be available for future reference.

Do not archive active documents.

14. Document Disposal

When documents are no longer required:

1. Verify that they are no longer needed.
2. Confirm that a backup exists if necessary.
3. Delete unnecessary duplicate copies.
4. Empty the Recycle Bin only after confirming deletion.

Never delete important project documentation without careful review.

15. Roles and Responsibilities

The system owner is responsible for:

- Creating documents.
- Naming files correctly.
- Organizing folders.
- Performing backups.
- Maintaining documentation.
- Reviewing permissions.
- Updating project records.

16. Best Practices

- Save files directly into the correct folder.
- Use consistent filenames.
- Review folders regularly.
- Archive completed work.
- Remove duplicate files.
- Keep documentation current.
- Perform scheduled backups.
- Verify important files after saving.

17. Common Mistakes to Avoid

Avoid:

- Saving files with generic names.
- Leaving files on the Desktop permanently.
- Keeping multiple unnecessary copies.
- Ignoring version control.
- Failing to back up important documents.
- Mixing unrelated documents in one folder.
- Deleting files without verification.

18. Related Documents

- User Guide
- Digital Filing System Folder Structure Guide
- File Naming Convention Guide
- Digital Filing Best Practices Guide
- Folder Creation Procedure
- File Organization Procedure
- Document Filing Procedure
- Procedure for Saving Files
- File Retrieval Procedure
- File Backup and Recovery Procedure
- Archive Management Procedure
- Duplicate File Management Procedure

- File Permission Management Procedure
 - Screenshot Capture Procedure
 - GitHub Publishing Procedure
 - LinkedIn Publishing Procedure
-

19. Conclusion

Effective document management is the foundation of a reliable digital filing system. By following the standards described in this guide, users can ensure that documents remain organized, secure, accessible, and easy to maintain throughout their lifecycle. Consistent document management improves productivity, supports collaboration, protects valuable information, and demonstrates professional records management practices.